INCH-POUND

A-A-20120B
April 16, 1997
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20120A
March 10, 1992

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# VEGETABLES, MIXED, CANNED

**The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.**

## 1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers canned mixed vegetables, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

## 2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Ingredients: The mixed vegetables shall be prepared from clean, sound, properly-matured vegetables, which are fresh, fresh-brined, or frozen prior to processing. The grade for each individual vegetable shall be U.S. Grade A, except that sweet peas and yellow corn may be U.S. Grade B or better for maturity.

2.2 Additional ingredients: In addition to those ingredients specified in paragraph 2.5.1 of this CID, the mixed vegetables may contain added as a garnish (such as small pieces of onion, sweet red peppers, or green peppers) in an amount less than 2 percent of the total drained weight.

2.3 Liquid packing media: Liquid packing media shall be clear and free from sediment and may contain additives such as onion powder or calcium salts permitted by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration.

**Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.**

FSC 8915

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2.4 Finished product:

2.4.1 Flavor and odor: The mixed vegetables shall have a characteristic flavor and odor.

2.4.2 Color: Each type of vegetable shall have characteristic color.

2.5 Drained weight: The average drained weight shall not be less than 10.0 ounces (0.35g) for 303 x 406 cans and 65.0 ounces (2.29g) for 603 x 700 cans.

2.5.1 Vegetable types and percentages of total drained weight:

| Type of vegetable 1/ | Total drained weight (Minimum percent) | (Maximum percent) |
|---|---|---|
| Carrots (Diced) 2/ | 33 | 52 |
| Potatoes (Diced) | 17 | 35 |
| Lima beans, thin seeded | 1 | 12 |
| Peas, sweet | 3 | 12 |
| Beans, green (Short cut, cut, or mixed) | 3 | 12 |
| Corn, yellow (Whole kernel) | 4 | 8 |
| Celery (Cut, 1/2 inch maximum in length) | 2 | 9 |

1/ The combined weight of the carrots and potatoes shall not be more than 72 percent of the net drained weight.

2/ Not larger than 3/8 x 3/8 x 3/4 inches (0.95 x 0.95 x 1.91 cm) nor smaller than 3/8 x 3/8 x 3/8 inches (0.95 x 0.95 x 0.95 cm).

## 3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 The delivered canned mixed vegetables shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the canned mixed vegetables in the commercial marketplace. Delivered mixed vegetables shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Product conformance. The canned mixed vegetables provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and



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quality assurance practices, and be the same canned mixed vegetables offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 Quality assurance. When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that canned mixed vegetables quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The canned mixed vegetables shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

## 5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

## 6. NOTES.

6.1 Sources of documents.

6.1.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Copies of the U.S. Standards for Grades of processed vegetables are available from: **Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Stop 0247, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0247**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**



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**CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:**

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

**PREPARING ACTIVITY:**

USDA - FV



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